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## **Was Pakistan a state at all 1947-1971?**

A major problem in the practice of history in our country is the lack of continuity. We usually don't even pay much attention to it. Many of us think that our history began on August 14, 1947. After Pakistan, the incident of Bangladesh is deeply embedded in our minds. Since we are somewhat involved in bureaucratic thinking; We like to think gadget-wise. We think that once there was Pakistan; From that Pakistan we came out etc. More than that we do not know or care to know. We are not interested in your information. We are emotional. We abuse Pakistan. But don't try to understand why our problem is created. This is the first thing.

The second thing is that when we consider forty-seven as halal, we basically consider middle-class colonialist institutions and processes as halal. And then we give less importance to the anti-colonial movement of the common people. We think that the date fixed by the colonists, the decision given is correct. This is because our practice of history is limited. But actually our history runs in two parallel streams. An institutional or bureaucratic system. The other is the social stream or people's stream. Now we have to decide which way to go.

On August 14, 1947, a political government called Pakistan was born - that's right. But I disagree whether Pakistan was a state at all. Because so much was done to create the state, that 'state' ended in just 24 years! We have to ask this question from the standpoint of history. Because Jinnah's Pakistan was only 24 years old. From there, Yahya Khan's Pakistan – born on 16 December 1971; His age is passing 50 years. Now Yahya's Pakistan is surviving twice as old as Jinnah's Pakistan. That's why I think the construction of Pakistan now is the right construction. That kind of governance at that center in that area may be acceptable to Pakistanis, but a 'state' of Bangladesh and Pakistan, created in 1947, is false, and more importantly, has no historical background and continuity.



We protested against Pakistan. But in that movement we have reduced the constructs of our own analytical framework. That is why we are stuck thinking only that Pakistan was a communal state. Indeed nationalist states are also communal. We do not think that when we say it is a Bengali state - we are also being communal. Perhaps we distinguish between communalism, then – as good communalism and bad communalism. Nationalism is also being questioned these days. I myself do not think that there was any need to create a state just for being a Bengali. Because the movement to establish Bangladesh has been going on for a long time; And that state is the state of common people, the state of marginalized people. Historically it was a separate country long ago. It was sometimes unaffiliated, sometimes subjugated, sometimes totally independent at different stages in different states. Like in seventy one.

We have to realize that the basic formula or the main strength of the state is its historical experience. From that point of view, the historical experience of Bangladesh and the historical experience of Pakistan are not the same. Our enemy and their enemy are not the same. Because of this, when Pakistan was born, the fundamental conflict came to light. If we were people of one state or one country then conflict would not have started between us from the first day. The reason for the conflict is that we have this different history. The people of Bangladesh and the people of Pakistan actually wanted a different kind of state. And the talk of creating a state based on cultural identity is all middle-class talk. But we could not bring the role or experience of ordinary people in our practice. A big reason for that is probably that our conceptions of history are heavily influenced by colonialism.

**1940 or 47?**

In 1940, the All India Muslim League passed a resolution called the Lahore Resolution. In order to make it very clear that there will be two separate states for the majority of Muslims. There will be one state for the eastern region of India and another for the western region of India. It is clearly written and on this basis the movement for the formation of a state in Bangladesh was also made in the name of independent East Pakistan.

During the movement that took place from 1940 to 1946, many meetings were held in the name of independent East Pakistan. A much discussed article by Abul Hashim was also published called 'Independent East Pakistan'. Besides, an organization called East Pakistan Renaissance Society was also formed in which later many members of Awami League joined. But then this political reality of East Pakistan was ended in 1946.

Why was the year 1940 proposed? This is because the Bengal Muslim League and Krishak Praja Party won in the elections held in 1937 in what is today Bangladesh. Nowhere else did they win so massively. Pakistan's proposal was made mainly with this population in mind. And Shere Bangla AK Fazlul Haque was allowed to move the motion as he was the then Prime Minister of Bengal. Just as the 1940 proposal centered on the 1937 election, in the same way when the Muslim League won as a single political party in Bangladesh in the 1946 election, Muhammad Ali Jinnah saw that it was going to be a separate country; over which he will have no control.



At that time, Muhammad Ali Jinnah presented the One Pakistan proposal at a meeting of newly elected Muslim League legislators in Delhi. After Muhammad Ali Jinnah put forward this proposal of a separate state, Abul Hashim, the general secretary of the Bengali Provincial

Muslim League, strongly opposed it and said, 'It is not right. It is not in the Lahore proposal.' Jinnah Sahib said, 'Who said it is not right.' Then the resolution book was brought. It was rightly seen that 'states' is written there. But Muhammad Ali Jinnah then said that it must have been a typing error. A new complication began. To solve this situation, it was proposed that a vote should be taken. Muhammad Ali Jinnah won that vote in favor of forming a single state instead of states.

Abul Hashim returned from there and started the first state formation movement for Bengali 'United Bengal Movement'. Abul Hashim started this movement by joining the Bengali Congress. And surprisingly, Muhammad Ali Jinnah again supported the movement against his own Pakistan state proposal. But if East Pakistan was really an integral part of Pakistan, would he have supported this proposal? I think both the Delhi Resolution of 1946 and the Joint Bengal Resolution of 1947 - Jinnah showed political dishonesty. But if Jinnah had a good understanding of history, he would have understood that the state cannot be sustained with such rigor. That is why the day Pakistan was proposed in 1946, the same day Pakistan was given death sentence. Historical reality confirmed the birth of both Pakistan and Bangladesh on the same date, 26 March 1971. Hence, 'Pakistan' was not bifurcated in 1971, but became a logical legacy of its own history. Historically, Pakistan was not a state in 1947. Originally, Pakistan was born in 1971.



### East Bengal to Bangladesh

The history of the people of East Bengal is a long history of struggle. The people of East Bengal have struggled more than any other people in the whole of India. Because of that, the struggle of

those people definitely could not be stopped. After '47, the movement started in '48. One by one movement of fifty, movement of fifty-two, movement of fifty-four - thus fifty-six, fifty-eight, sixty-two, sixty-six, seventy-nine, seventy, seventy-one. These movements were inevitable for us. So if anyone gave death sentence to Pakistan, it was given by its founder Muhammad Ali Jinnah himself.

Ever since the creation of Pakistan, West Pakistanis started mistreating us. Which once we could not bear anymore, separated. But the point is to try to understand why Pakistan misbehaved with us. If both parties are citizens of the same country, then there is no scope for abuse. But the misbehavior was because those who were in power in Pakistan, those who were in power in India or the Indian Congress, were actually people from the same place. ie North Indian. But these are the occupying forces in the whole of India. But we cannot think that the region called Bengal, i.e. this Bengal, was actually occupied by them repeatedly. And this was occupied either by those who did the Congress or the Muslim League later on. This land was occupied by Aryans, occupied by Central Asians, occupied by Mongols, occupied by Afghans. But the people of Bengal have a kind of love towards the invaders. A review of history shows that we live in a similar culture. Here the tendency to cheat for survival is considered simple. Especially our middle class has always depended on this kind of culture.

What is the politics of Bengal then? Was there no politics in Bengal before the British came here in 1757? There was - but a movement can never take place through a single class alone. When they are collective, movement is seen to originate from within that collective class. Before the arrival of the British, the class that was not here outside the common people of Bengal was this middle class. Those who were expelled or harmed early after the arrival of the British were seen as the first rebellious class. The first rebellion in the region against the British took place in 1760 - the Fakir-Sanyas movement. The movement of the fakir-sannyasis shows that it was the dispossessed, the middle class who used to extort money from the village people, that started the first rebellion. That class itself is never singularly powerful. The oppressed peasants of Bengal are usually associated with them. After researching, it will be seen that from 1757 to 1793 there were many revolts in Bengal. These revolts were organized jointly and involved Hindu and Muslim peasants.

After 1793 this rebellion subsided somewhat when the zamindari system was introduced. The zamindari system gave benefits to the Hindu Bengali community. The educated Hindu Bengali population of Calcutta no longer led the general Hindu population to enjoy the benefits of the zamindari system. And when the middle class is not willing to lead, it becomes very difficult for the poor alone to agitate. The issue of this joint movement is also applicable to our liberation war of 1971.

Looking at almost all the movements and struggles including the 1970s in Bangladesh, it can be seen that in most cases the movements were led by the middle class; The power came from the

peasantry. And when two classes struggle together, they succeed.

After 1793 the Bengali Hindu middle class left for the British. Since they were the most privileged class for the first hundred years of the colonial period, they were not interested in the Hindu peasantry. The landlord can no longer agitate for the people. Hence the Hindu peasantry became completely leaderless. This burden on the Bengali Hindu peasantry made them the most unopposed oppressed group. In 1971 they were the most persecuted for that reason. But those who became zamindars had no previous experience of running a zamindari. They did not know how to run a zamindari or what to do to run it. They had some inherited money and mostly business money - based on that they bought zamindari. But they did not have the skills to collect the land rent. The British passed many laws and privileges to collect rent from the peasants in their villages, all of which were oppressive. Even after that he was not able to. Basically nothing was coming to the British from the Zamindari system. Then in 1811, the British introduced the intermediary system. As a result, the British became somewhat dependent on middlemen. And since the middlemen were not centered in Calcutta, their sphere of influence in the villages became much larger. They also knew the English and the peasants. So it became much easier for them to be historically strong.

The class that bought the zamindari, i.e. the Babu Samaj based in Calcutta, were mainly interested in jobs and advocacy. That is, they were educated people. When the British occupied Bengal, there were hardly any educated Bengali middle class Muslims. Through mediation, a section of them became educated and started their journey towards job-advocacy. When they started demanding jobs and civic benefits, they were confronted by the established elite class, the Bengali Hindus. From this vantage point, Bengali Hindus and Bengali Muslims stand as adversaries. By 1857 it was very clear that as the rebellion was going on in the villages, so was the movement for employment in the cities. The advantage of Bengali Muslim society was its greater contact with the village peasants and the English as middlemen. So it was easy for him to apply pressure. The English, on the other hand, knew that the two middle classes were dependent on it, but not the peasantry. Therefore, the British policy was by no means uniform. He has adopted different policies with each group for his own benefit.





When the Sepoy Mutiny broke out in 1857, the peasantry was one of the major forces - but the role of the peasantry in this is little heard; Everyone talks about Rani of Jhansi, Bahadur Shah Zafar etc.; That is, about the elite class. But they were not in any power! Sepoys are basically people from the peasant class. No one talks about those farmers. We carefully avoid or isolate the role of ordinary people. We are willing to give opportunities to the middle class and even the upper class, but we are not willing to see the lower class or marginalized people in any important role.

However, the British undertook several schemes for the betterment of the peasantry; Tried to provide various facilities to facilitate their survival. Because the British were always worried about the farmers. The British used to say, 'We cannot deny the landlords, they are our friends. But what do we do with these farmers, they give us the most pain.' Englishman Sir Charles Metcalf said this. But this reality about the farmers of Bengal is not seen in the history of our country. Our history has been constructed in the middle-class history. We are moving forward with him.

Bengal was partitioned in 1905. The people of East Bengal were in favor of it. What the British did - firstly tried to weaken the Calcutta based class. Secondly, they tried to give opportunity to a new class based in Dhaka as their opponent. and thirdly, tried to favor the peasants, as they knew that the peasants were a militant class, whom the British had the greatest difficulty in dealing with.

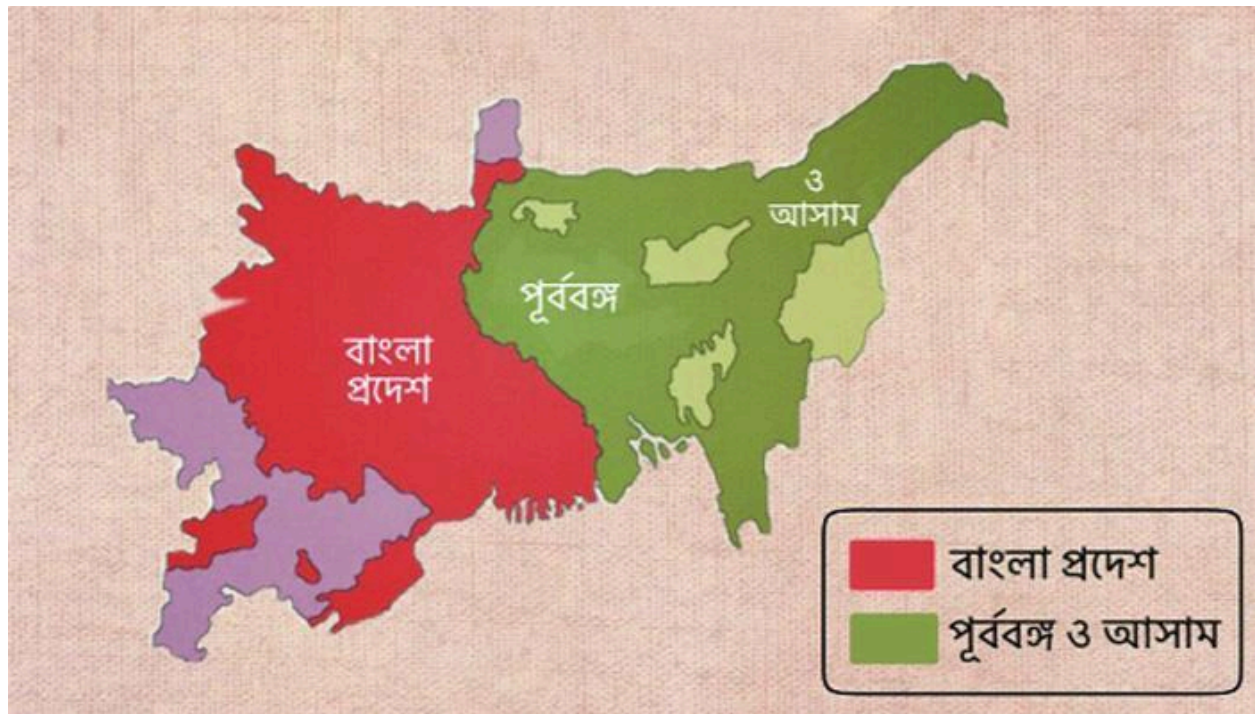
The people of East Bengal, especially the peasantry, saw the appearance of a future state for the first time during the partition of Bengal. Basically the year 1905 is important because this is the face of Bangladesh. The first document in the documents of the Liberation War is about East

Bengal, that is, how East Bengal was created. That is, the main historians of Bangladesh are also historically admitting that if we are going to catch the sources of this country, then we have to catch the sources of East Bengal. Geographically it shows that this is your country. And that appearance was originally created in 1905. But what the British failed to grasp was, how strong were the middle class of Calcutta whom we call 'Swadeshi'? In reality they were very powerful; And in 1911 they really turned the tide of Bengal. They canceled the secession of Bengal, and there was enough joy; But then the established middle class of Calcutta and the rising middle class of Dhaka were never united; That wasn't even a possibility. It was already clear that there was no possibility. After 1911 that possibility ended. In other words, the two middle classes have never been together. In 1923, when Deshbandhu Chittaranjan Das tried to provide benefits to the Muslim Bengali middle class through the Bengal Pact, the Hindu Bengali middle class resisted and broke it. The first election was held in 1937. The majority of the population in the elections were Bengali Muslims. Naturally, their team will win. The right and power of the majority has been proved in this election of 1937. So far the minorities have been trying to prevent this right in various ways. But after the election, that was no longer possible.

### **Pakistan and the majority**

Within Pakistan too, the tendency to deny the majority was strong. It was also prevalent in Congress politics. Later, after 1947, it was also dominant in the politics of the Central Muslim League. That is, this political and historical trend of denying the people of East Bengal has continued. If you look at it this way, the matter becomes relatively simple.





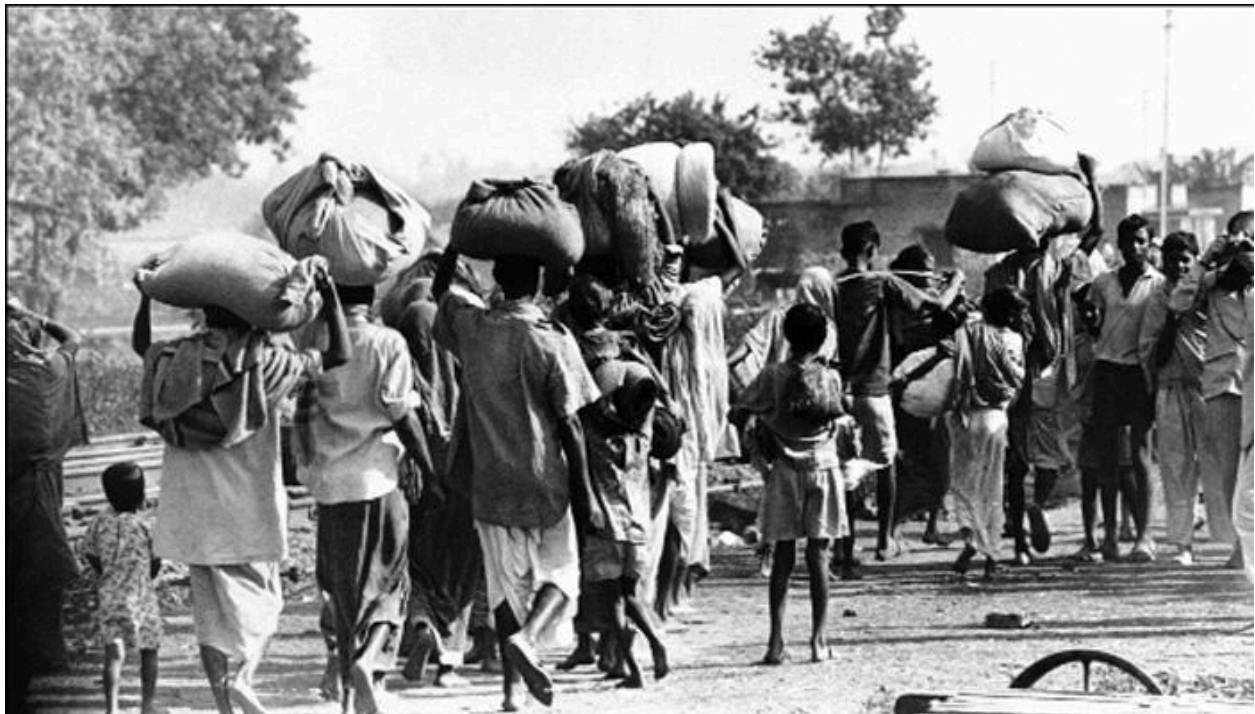
After 1949 Bengal Muslim League became Awami Muslim League one day. By whatever name it is called, it is a group of people from East Bengal or East Pakistan. That is, everyone joined the same party en masse or the signboard of the party only changed, people and politics remained the same. Here's the thing about consistency.

What the historians of our country do is - Pakistan does it, Muslim League does it, Awami League does it. In terms of consistency, Pakistan is also consistently progressing, India is also consistently progressing and we are also consistently progressing. We are not part of either and have hostile relations with both. We often call India's ideas good while calling Pakistan bad. When it comes to insulting Pakistan, I think the reasoning of Indians is correct. We call Pakistan communal. But Calcutta is equally communal. If they were not communal then why occupied Bengal? If it was not communal, why did the people of Calcutta stop what the farmer wanted? If it was not communal, why did they reject the Bengal Pact of 1923? Who is not communal? In fact the formula of communalism is to gain or protect benefits. I think any community does politics for its own benefit. This is the reality. And if one denies, the other takes more advantage, one day he will protest. If that protest goes to an extreme stage then there will be a clash. So did we.

### Some important dates

These dates are very important. Pakistan was proposed in 1940 after the elections of 1937. After the elections of 1946, it was proposed to break up the two separate Pakistans and make one Pakistan. And in 1947 the joint Bengal movement took place. Congress initially supported it;

Even Jinnah supported it. But later Congress again opposed it and dissolved it. It turns out that Jinnah had no such fondness for Pakistan; Instead, he was basically trying to occupy a different place for himself. If he had so much moral love for Pakistan and if Pakistan was a moral construct - why would he agree with the Congress to treat East Pakistan as a separate country? This is because of Jinnah's dishonesty. Jinnah repeatedly testified to this dishonesty. And that's why he called Pakistan a dishonest state or a confused state - it did not last as a state.



When the joint Bengal movement broke up in 1947, the biggest pressure came from Nehru. Nehru did not want it to be separated. Nehru did not want Bengalis to have a separate state. But it cannot be denied that the whole initiative of the Bengali state of Bengal was taken only once - it was the Bengali Congress that proposed and broke it. And Nehru had the most pressure on them.

### **Inner Group and Independent Bangladesh**

When the joint Bengal movement broke up, the youth workers of the Bengali Muslim League formed a separate party. The secret group started working under the name 'Inner Group'. Its head was Moazzem Ahmed Chowdhury. This **Moazzem Ahmed Chowdhury** was a close friend of Sheikh Mujibur Rahman.



### Language Movement

Our mainstream historians don't think much about it. They prefer to start the discussion only from forty-seven and fifty-two. But there is not much discussion about the struggle of the people of East Bengal, the struggle of the farmers, the struggle of the workers against the British rule for two hundred years. I say fifty-two years is definitely very important. But Bayannar language movement is middle class movement. Historically the role of the fifty-two year old may have inspired the middle class, not so much touched the common people. However, this movement helped a lot in connecting the middle class with the struggle of the lower class people.

Common people fight for livelihood, revolt for livelihood. The middle class also struggles for a living. The thing that stood out in fifty-two years is that you have to learn Urdu to get a job. The Bengalis of East Pakistan will not get job benefits until they learn Urdu. So the main point of the language movement was to get jobs or economic benefits. Culture is a part of course, but the key was that they have to take the exam in Urdu. Then they will be left out again. For the reason they did Pakistan, that is, for job benefits; And for which since 1857 this Bengali Muslim rising broker class or rising Muslim middle class of Bengal has been trying. Now, if they don't get that job-goat opportunity, then what is the benefit for Pakistan. That's why they got into the language movement so quickly. But the movement of 1971 was the movement of common people, the movement of farmers.



Liberation War: 1971

If you notice, it will be seen that the movement of these farmers has never stopped in terms of continuity. Rebellion is going on one after another. And it was from these peasants that the biggest rebellion emerged in 1971. The history of the struggle of the peasants by agitating with the British has taken different forms at different stages and times. And finally his most successful release came in 1971. Even if you look at the 1970 elections, you can see how many votes there were from the people of the city and how many were the votes of the people from the villages. By doing this calculation, it can be seen that the foundation of Bangladesh was created by whose vote? It was never built on the middle class vote. Common people's vote in 1937 election, common people's vote in 1946 election, even common people's majority in 1954 election and lastly in 1970. History has gone where the majority says. Because of this, the disintegration of Pakistan was not destined, Pakistan did not exist. A state or administrative structure could be said to have been built by forceful tactics, but that was unreal. That unreality inevitably ended, as Pakistan was an army-dependent anti-Indian state, nothing more. And it is still there today. That is why our history does not find any connection with Pakistan. We are trying to become middle class by associating the peasant history with ourselves. What can the history of Pakistan have to do with that history? What has happened - the strategically oppressed class is the peasantry. And the most oppressed among them are Bengali Muslims and Hindu farmers. And the Hindu peasantry has no middle class. The Bengali middle class has associated itself with the Bengali Muslim peasantry to get benefits. Received benefits. This is the source of history. It takes two classes. But since one class was middle class, the other class was not, the leadership of the first class was created by those who brokered more with the English. There was another class who

basically rebelled. Our Bangladesh today is based on this.

By the time Pakistan came from the middle, there had been at least three attempts to become Bangladesh. From 1905 to 1911 East Bengal was a vice state. It was declared as a separate state in 1940. And in 1947 an attempt was made to establish Bangladesh as an independent state. So Pakistan had no historical basis here. **A person's identity is not what religion or language he is born into, but what history he is born into. Therefore, until we understand our history, we will never know ourselves. Till then we have to say that we are born from Pakistan, this is unrealistic. We need to know that we have an independent individual being, a history, in order to discover ourselves.**